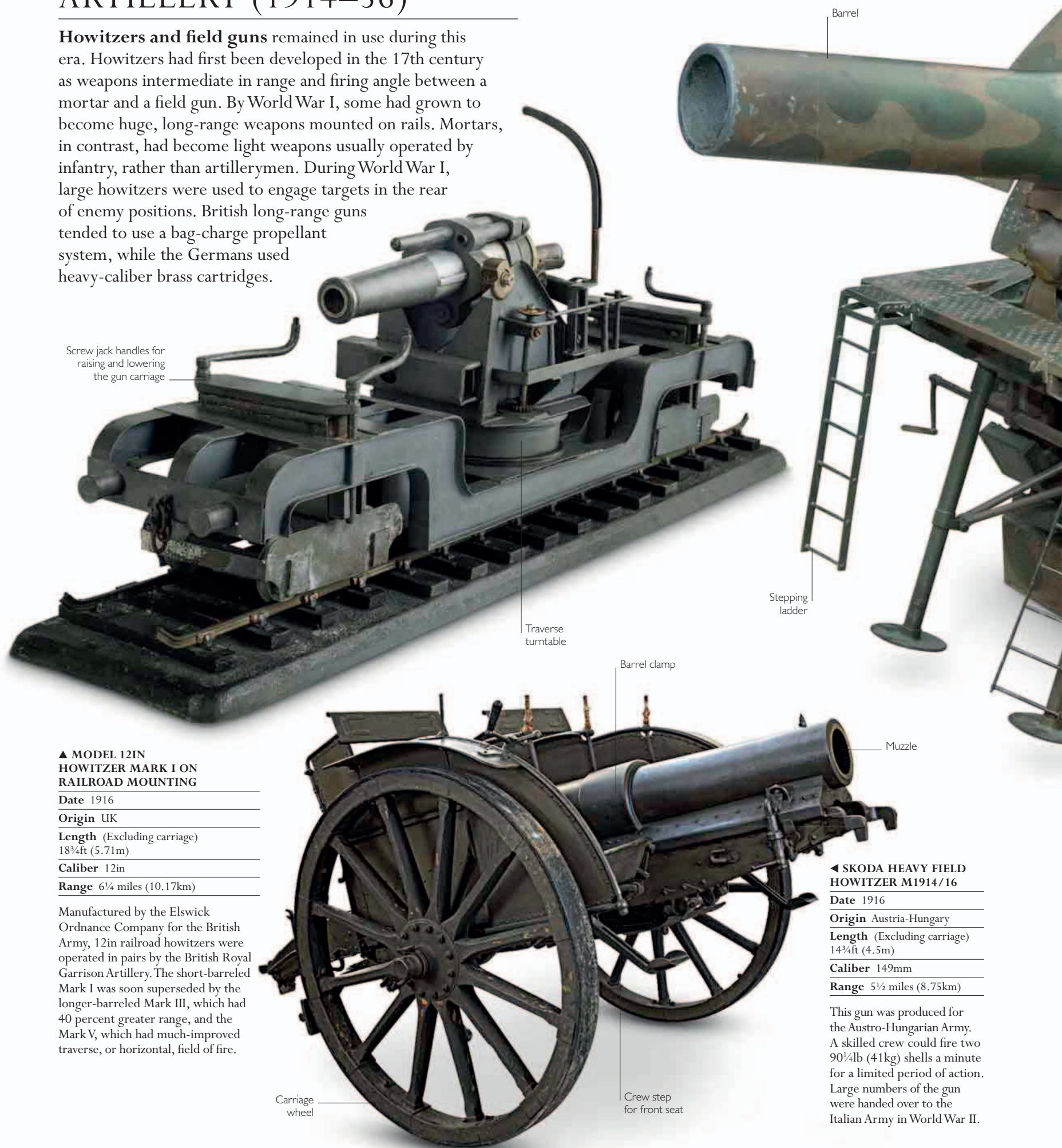


## ARTILLERY (1914–36)

**Howitzers and field guns** remained in use during this era. Howitzers had first been developed in the 17th century as weapons intermediate in range and firing angle between a mortar and a field gun. By World War I, some had grown to become huge, long-range weapons mounted on rails. Mortars, in contrast, had become light weapons usually operated by infantry, rather than artillerymen. During World War I, large howitzers were used to engage targets in the rear of enemy positions. British long-range guns tended to use a bag-charge propellant system, while the Germans used heavy-caliber brass cartridges.



### ▲ MODEL 12IN HOWITZER MARK I ON RAILROAD MOUNTING

**Date** 1916

**Origin** UK

**Length** (Excluding carriage)  
18¾ft (5.71m)

**Caliber** 12in

**Range** 6¼ miles (10.17km)

Manufactured by the Elswick Ordnance Company for the British Army, 12in railroad howitzers were operated in pairs by the British Royal Garrison Artillery. The short-barreled Mark I was soon superseded by the longer-barreled Mark III, which had 40 percent greater range, and the Mark V, which had much-improved traverse, or horizontal, field of fire.

### ◀ SKODA HEAVY FIELD HOWITZER M1914/16

**Date** 1916

**Origin** Austria-Hungary

**Length** (Excluding carriage)  
14¾ft (4.5m)

**Caliber** 149mm

**Range** 5½ miles (8.75km)

This gun was produced for the Austro-Hungarian Army. A skilled crew could fire two 90¼lb (41kg) shells a minute for a limited period of action. Large numbers of the gun were handed over to the Italian Army in World War II.